

SCITI 2026

Smart City Thailand Index

Reality, not ribbon-cutting.

Digital Economy Promotion Agency (depa)
Ministry of Digital Economy and Society (MDES)
Kingdom of Thailand

SLIC (Smart Liveable Cities Index) Methodology
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Pronounced "City" (silent S, like Latin)

1. Executive Summary

Thailand has certified 37 smart cities across 4 batches since 2019. But how many of them actually work? This index exists because the gap between announcements and outcomes needed measuring. We score cities on what citizens experience on the ground — not what got presented on a slide deck.

118 cities tracked. 39 operational. 15 Alpha tier. Built on SLIC methodology with 7 weighted pillars: Livability (25%), Economy (20%), Safety (15%), Wellbeing (15%), Environment (10%), Hospitality (10%), Digital (5%).

The scoring formula: **Composite** = $\Sigma (\text{Pillar}_i \times \text{Weight}_i) / \Sigma \text{Weights}$. Each pillar is scored 0–100 from verifiable public data sources. Tier assignment is automatic: Alpha ≥ 65, Beta 45–64, Gamma < 45.

2. Top 10 Cities

Rank	City	Province	Score	Tier	Reality
1	Phuket Smart City	Phuket	72.8	Alpha	Operational
2	Samyan Smart City	Bangkok	72.4	Alpha	Operational
3	Chiang Mai Smart Old Town	Chiang Mai	71.1	Alpha	Operational
4	Khon Kaen Smart City	Khon Kaen	70.2	Alpha	Operational
5	CMU Smart City	Chiang Mai	70.1	Alpha	Operational
6	Saensuk Smart City	Chon Buri	67.5	Alpha	Operational
7	Phra Ram 4 Smart City	Bangkok	66.9	Alpha	Operational
8	Krabi Smart City	Krabi	66.5	Alpha	Operational
9	Chachoengsao Smart City	Chachoengsao	66.4	Alpha	Operational
10	Hat Yai Smart City	Songkhla	66.1	Alpha	Operational

3. Scoring Methodology

Seven pillars, each scored 0–100 from verifiable public data:

Pillar	Weight	Signals
Livability	25%	Housing, transit, infrastructure, utilities
Economy	20%	Jobs, GPP per capita, growth, affordability
Safety	15%	Crime rate, disaster resilience, road safety
Wellbeing	15%	Healthcare, education, mental health, birth confidence
Environment	10%	Air quality (PM2.5), green space, water, waste
Hospitality	10%	Culture, community, belonging, tourism
Digital	5%	IoT adoption, data platforms, AI, sensors

Tier classification: Alpha ≥ 65 (operational infrastructure) | Beta 45–64 (building, partial) | Gamma < 45 (planning stage)

4. Data Sources (15+)

- National Statistical Office (NSO) — population, income, employment
- NESDC — Gross Provincial Product (GPP) per capita
- Pollution Control Department (PCD) — PM2.5 from 70+ stations
- GISTDA — satellite-derived green coverage, urban sprawl
- World Bank Open Data — GDP growth, Gini coefficient
- Asian Development Bank (ADB) — ACGF, infrastructure finance
- Open-Meteo / Copernicus — climate data cross-validation
- Royal Thai Police — crime statistics per province
- DOPA — population registry, migration data
- depa City Data Platform (citydata.in.th) — IoT, citizen engagement
- Ministry of Public Health — hospital beds, healthcare access
- Board of Investment (BOI) — FDI, promoted projects
- ONEP — Environmental Performance Index
- Royal Forest Department — forest cover by province
- Field observation — direct site verification by research team

5. Financial Toolkit

15 financial instruments mapped to city tiers and development stages, based on the ASEAN Smart City Financing Toolkit, ADB ASEAN Catalytic Green Finance Facility (ACGF), Thailand SEC Green Bond Framework, and BOI S-Curve investment incentives.

- PPP (THB 500M–10B+)
- Green/Climate Bond (THB 1–20B)
- Land Value Capture (THB 200M–5B)
- Municipal Revenue Bond (THB 500M–5B)
- Build-Operate-Transfer (THB 200M–5B)
- Regional Development Finance (ADB/JICA/WB)
- Blended Finance Vehicle (THB 100M–5B)
- BOI Digital Economy Incentives
- National Government Transfer (THB 5–200M)
- Technical Assistance Grant (THB 1–50M)
- Civic Crowdfunding (THB 100K–10M)
- On-Bill Financing (THB 10–500M)
- Smart City SEZ (THB 5B–100B+)
- Land Pooling (THB 200M–2B)
- Asset Recycling (THB 500M–10B)

6. Standards Alignment

- UN-Habitat City Prosperity Initiative (CPI)
- ISO 37122:2019 — Sustainable Cities: Indicators for Smart Cities
- UN Sustainable Development Goal 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities)
- ASEAN Smart Cities Framework (ASCF) 2018
- ASEAN Smart Cities Action Plan (ASCAP) 2021–2025

- New Urban Agenda 2016
- Thailand PPP Act B.E. 2562 (2019)

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